the big spenders like Greece, Hungary, Brazil and Phillipines who spent at least 16 percent of their GDP on stimulus, suffered higher inflation, higher interest rates and currency depreciation.' The reason he explains is that, 'Overspending often backfires, particularly in developing nations. They lack the financial credibility to ramp up spending without unbalancing the economy, and end up getting punished by global markets.'[6] Other noteworthy economists also shared similar views. R. Jagannathan published a piece titled 'Modi's socio-nomics starts to pay off' in the *Business Standard* on 2 November 2021 where he plainly predicted what could lie ahead for India. He predicted that a $10-trillion economy by 2030–32, a Sensex at 1,00,000 by 2025, monthly GST revenues at ₹2 trillion by 2024–25, 100 new unicorns by 2025 and poverty below 5 per cent by 2030 was well within reach.[7]

When India was crafting its economic response to the pandemic and very mindfully took the modified barbell approach, many people on the opposite side of the spectrum took a jaundiced view that India should have given large cash hand-outs like other countries. In May 2020, 20 opposition parties, led by the Congress, had demanded that ₹7,500 should be transferred to each family.[8] However, the prime minister took the explicit view that Indians by nature are not spenders, they are savers. He told his economic advisors that he was of the opinion that any cash hand-outs would not be used to purchase goods and services which was the purpose of the hand-outs in the first place—to influx cash into the markets. Instead, he believed that Indians will save the money for financial security, thus, making the policy goal of a cash handout counterproductive. He was aware through his decades of experience living among the people that the cash given out would not flow into the market, thus unable to stimulate it, as intended.

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In preparation for the imminent third wave, the Empowered Group 1, led by Dr Paul, had recommended in its July 2021 report, taking into account experiences from countries affected by the third wave, that a third surge of infections were likely to be as intense or slightly higher than the second wave, and that India should prepare for handling about four to five lakh cases per day. In terms of infrastructure preparedness, this would translate